THE BUILDING OF THE BIBLE

SHOWING

THE CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER IN WHICH THE BOOKS OF THE OLD AND NEW TESTAMENTS APPEARED ACCORDING TO RECENT BIBLICAL CRITICISM

With Notes on Contemporary Events

BY

F. J. GOULD,

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Fourth Edition

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In the following pages a view is given of the various stages in the building-up of the Bible into its present form. The books of the Bible, as they stand in the common version, by no means follow in the order of their original composition. For example, the first chapter of the Book of Genesis is much younger than the greater part of the second chapter—that is to say, it was written many years afterwards. Our task, therefore, is to reconstruct the whole of the Hebrew and Christian sacred literature, and place the various portions in chronological order. Of course, in most cases it will not be possible to fix the date with exactness. Often all we can say is that a book first appeared in such and such a century. Nor may we dogmatically assert that the particular order here given is indisputable. All we can justly affirm is that our scheme represents in a general way the manner in which the component parts of the Bible followed one after the other, from the eleventh century B.C. to the second C.E. (Christian Era).

Eleventh Century B.C.—The *Song of Deborah and Barak* is probably the oldest fragment of the Bible literature (Judges v.). It celebrates the victory of the tribes Issachar, Naphtali, Zabulon, and Manasseh over the Canaanites. Full of fire and brutal lust for vengeance, it is yet combined with a poetic loyalty towards Yahveh, the God who issues amid tempest and lightning from the rocks of Edom and Sinai.

Note.—The Babylonian king Hammurabi published (by means of inscribed pillars, tablets, etc.) a Code of some three hundred laws, dealing with slavery, marriage, sorcery, trade, crime, etc., the date of

Hammurabi being more than 2000 B.C. The Egyptian book of moral precepts known as the "Maxims of Ptahhotep" dates about 3550 B.C. Portions of the sacred writings, entitled the "Book of the Dead," were engraved on Egyptian sarcophagi older than 2000 B.C. The famous Tell-el-Amarna letters (correspondence between the courts of Babylonia and Egypt, written in Babylonian cuneiform characters) belong to the reign of Amenophis IV., in the fourteenth century B.C.

From the Eleventh to the Eighth Century B.C.—A number of war songs and lyrics have come down to us from this period, such as the *Sword Song*, in which Lamech chants the deadly power of the warrior's blade (Gen. iv.); the *Blessing of Jacob*, which tells of the prophetic gifts which old Israel bestowed upon his twelve sons (Gen. xlix.); the *Red Sea Triumph Song* (Ex. xv.); the *Song of Moses*, descriptive of God, the Rock, who rescued Israel from the howling wilderness and placed him in a fat and pleasant land (Deut. xxxii.); and the *Blessing of Moses*, which allots promises of good things to the twelve Hebrew tribes (Deut. xxx.).

To this period we may also assign the *Book of the Covenant*, an ancient collection of laws as to altar-building, slaves, manslaughter, sexual offences, witchcraft, usury, pledging of garments, slander, the Year of Rest, the Sabbath, and the Three Feasts—*i.e.*, Passover, First-fruits, and Harvest, etc. No doubt a number of the popular sayings, or *Proverbs*, would arise among the primitive Israelites, such as "Hope deferred maketh the heart sick," and other maxims contained in Proverbs x. to xxii. 16. Legends of the chieftains or *Judges* arose at this time—*e.g.*, the adventures of the Sun-god Samson. The dirges in which David mourned for valiant Saul and faithful Jonathan and the betrayed Abner also give forth the wild strain of this uncultured age.

Note.—By this time the writing of the sacred Zend-Avesta of Persia had been begun, the oldest portion of the scriptures being the Gathas, or hymns, of Zoroaster and his disciples. The Vedic books of the old Aryans of Central Asia had been in existence for a considerable period. Homer wrote his poems about the ninth century B.C. Rome was not

yet founded. Egypt was often disturbed by civil war; Shashank (Shishak) carried Egyptian arms victoriously into Palestine. The fortunes of Assyria were troubled until the great Assur-nasir-pal strengthened and extended the empire. The Phœnicians founded Carthage.

Eighth Century B.C.—Several prophets stirred the religious consciousness of the Hebrew people, and their impressive utterances were committed to writing with various additions and modifications. *Amos* declaimed passionately against the nations which clung to polytheism and refused to worship the purer God of the Jews; but he also prophesied against luxury and wine-drinking, and demanded a religion of justice instead of sacrifices and feasts. *Hosea* pleaded for a higher morality and cleaner modes of worship. *Micah* pronounced violent woes against oppressors, sorcerers, and corrupt judges, and foretold happier days when Israel should sit peacefully under its vine and fig-tree (Micah; first five chapters only). *Isaiah* eloquently censured sham piety and sinful love of wealth; called down wrath upon the surrounding nations who would not bow the knee to the Hebrew God Yahveh; and looked forward to a golden age when Zion should take the headship of the nations, and the sword of battle should be re-fashioned into the ploughshare of peace (Is. i. to xxxix., leaving out xiii. to xiv. 23, and xxiv. to xxvii.). The foundation of the books of *Samuel* was laid, embracing the main features of the picturesque biographies of Eli, Samuel, Saul, and David; incidents which we shall enumerate presently being added some time afterwards.

More important still, we now see the first emergence into written form of the national legends of the Creation, Flood, Patriarchs, Flight from Egypt, the Wilderness journey, the Giving of the Law, the Conquest of Canaan. Two writers committed these more or less fabulous histories to manuscript. One is called the *Yahvist*, because he refers to the deity by the name of "Yahveh" (the name is also met with in the forms of Jehovah, Jah, Yahu, Iao, etc.). The

legends which he records are these:—The Creation (beginning Genesis ii., second half of verse 4); the shaping of the woman from a rib; the Fall of Man; the murder of Abel; the rise of civilisation, music, etc.; the marriage of angels and earth-maidens; the dove and the olive-leaf; Noah's sacrifice after the Flood; the cursing of Canaan; the ruin of Babel; Abraham's falsehood to Pharaoh; Hagar's flight into the desert; Yahveh's visit to Abraham's tent; the perdition of Sodom; the grossness of Lot's daughters; Rebekah's romantic departure from her Mesopotamian home; Isaac's denial of his wife; Jacob's deception; his ingenious sheep-breeding; his wrestling with Yahveh; his reconciliation with Esau; Judah's licentiousness; parts of the story of Joseph; portions of the story of the Plagues of Egypt; the revelation of the Book of the Covenant; Balaam and his ass. The other is named the *Elohist*, because he refers to the deity as "Elohim" = God. To him we owe the following:—The promise of a numerous seed to Abraham; Abraham's denial of Sarah at Abimelech's court; the adventure of Hagar and Ishmael; Abraham's attempted sacrifice of Isaac; Jacob's ladder, and his flight from Laban; the burial of idols under the oak-tree; a considerable section of the Joseph legend, including the dream stories; Jacob's blessing of Ephraim and Manasseh; the adoption of Moses by Pharaoh's daughter; fragments of the Plague story and of the Exodus; the Ten Commandments; the appearance of God to the elders; the Golden Calf; Miriam's leprosy; the opening pages of the history of Balaam the seer.

Note.—In the eighth century Egypt suffered defeat from Assyria and Ethiopia. The Assyrian conqueror, Tiglath-Pileser III., carried away captive the Hebrew tribes on the east of the Jordan. In 722 the city of Samaria was captured, and a large number of Israelites belonging to the Ten Tribes were removed to Assyrian territory. Lycurgus flourished in Greece, Hesiod wrote his poems, and the walls of Rome were erected.

Seventh Century B.C.—A fragment of the book of *Micah* (vi. to vii. 6) was published. It represents Yahveh

on one side pleading against Israel on the other, and threatening disaster for vice, bribery, and wicked balances. The *Yahvist* and *Elohist* documents were now collected by some careful hand and joined together, with the addition of new matter, thus making up a large proportion of the books of Genesis and Exodus. The new matter comprised such incidents as the ensuing:—Moses' invocations at the removal and the resting of the ark (Num. x.); the fall of manna; the false report of the ten spies, and Moses' intercession for the rebellious people; the Brazen Serpent; Balaam's blessing of the tents of Jacob; Rahab and the spies; the passage of the Jordan; the siege of Jericho and the sin of Achan; the deceit of the Gibeonites; the sun and moon arrested; the struggle of Israel for the possession of various divisions of Canaan. *Zephaniah* called down catastrophes upon Judah and other nations, but the joyful strain at the conclusion would seem to be a later addition (iii. 14–20). *Nahum* raised a cry of vengeful joy when the city of Nineveh fell before the Babylonians and the Medes, and her proud walls were blackened by fire. *Habakkuk* tells us of the terror which the armies of Babylon awakened in Jerusalem, but he closes his prophecy with a devout and pathetic declaration of trust in the Yahveh who rules the everlasting mountains. About the year 621 the book of *Deuteronomy* was in all likelihood published, in order to give expression to a new development of religious thought, and to bring about a reformation in forms of worship. Old shrines and sacred figures were demolished by king Josiah in obedience to this supposed revelation from Yahveh. The new Law contained directions with respect to idolatry; witchcraft; the Passover, the First-fruits, and the Festival of Booths; slavery, sexual transgressions, murder; the conduct of war; gleaning customs, etc. It furnished a second version of the Ten Commandments, narrated the dramatic curses and blessings of Ebal and Gerizim, and closed with a full catalogue of the happy things in store for the nation if loyal

to its God, and of the miseries which would attend disobedience (Deut. v. to xxviii.). The first four chapters were attached at a later stage; also chapters xxix., xxx., xxxi. 1–13 and 23–29, and xxxiv. The earlier chapters of *Jeremiah* may have been written not long before the collapse of the Judæan kingdom. They breathe melancholy forebodings, and teem with remonstrances against the sins of the people; for the prophet believes the approaching invasion of the Babylonian forces is a direct result of a neglect of Yahveh's service, the burning of children in the fires of Tophet, the prevalence of adultery, theft, and murder. These earlier pages of Jeremiah's writings may, perhaps, include chapters i. to ix. 26 (omitting i. 3); x. 17 to xii. 6; xiv. to xx.; xxi. 11 to xxii. 19; and, possibly, other passages.

While none of the *Psalms* can be traced to David, there are some which appear to be pre-exilic, such as the following:—xxi. The king, wearing his golden crown, rejoices in the strength of Yahveh; xxviii. Yahveh the Rock is praised; xlvi. God gives peace from heathen assaults; xlviii. A celebration of Zion's beauty; lxi. The psalmist takes refuge in the Tabernacle; lxiii. The soul thirsts after God; lxxii. A coronation song; lxxvi. A hymn of triumph; lxxxix. A poem on the divine covenant; xc. The shortness of human life as contrasted with the divine; xci. Confidence in Yahveh's protection; ci. Pious resolutions; cxxxii. The prayer of the priests. Perhaps also ii., xviii., xx., xlv., which contain references to the king, date from before the exile.

Some portions of the book of *Zechariah* (ix. to xi., and xiii. 7–9) may have been written before the Babylonian captivity. They threaten the Philistines and other Gentiles, and promise the east Jordan tribes a delivery from Assyrian bondage.

Note.—About the middle of this century the power of Egypt revived under king Psammetichus, who greatly encouraged the settlement of Greeks and other foreigners in his country. His son Necho invaded

Syria, and defeated and slew Josiah, king of Judah. In the earlier years of the century Assyria was governed by Sennacherib; later on by the famous king Assur-bani-pal (668-626), the founder of the great clay-tablet library of Nineveh. On the fall of Nineveh the power of Babylon became pre-eminent, and it lasted till the rise of Cyrus. The Spartans were establishing themselves in the south of Greece, and had reduced the Helots to a degrading servitude. In Athens Draco enforced his severe code of laws; and this occurred about the same time that the people of Judah, under the inspiration of the book of Deuteronomy, were carrying out their religious reformation.

Sixth Century B.C.—Jerusalem was captured in 586. *Jeremiah* still continued to raise the warning and exhorting voice. He had been imprisoned by the Jewish king, but was set free by the invaders; his journey into Egypt with a body of fugitive Jews is described in the book that bears his name, together with his curses upon Egypt, Philistia, Moab, Ammon, Edom, and Syria. In the like gloomy key were recited the anonymous dirges known as the *Lamentations*. These poems portray the horrible condition of Jerusalem during the final siege by the Chaldæans. The poems are five in number, and in the first four the writer has followed the singular plan of beginning the verses, or groups of verses, with words of which the initials form the successive letters of the alphabet (Hebrew). The little book of *Obadiah* may have been composed now or later; it is a vigorous accusation of the cruelty of the people of Edom, the rocky district to the south-east of the Dead Sea. During the captivity of the Jews in Babylonia some of the more thoughtful exiles appear to have given a loving care to the preservation and copying of the written national traditions; and now, probably, the book of *Judges* was re-arranged, and the old legends of Othniel, Gideon, Jephthah, Samson, etc., combined with moral reflections, which do not, however, obscure the primitive folk-lore of an earlier time (Judges ii. 6 to xvi.). The other parts of the book do not betray this more modern thought; the story of Micah and his images, and the horrid tragedy of the concubine of Bethlehem, clearly came from a less cultured source.

The books of *Samuel* were revised, and portions seem to have been added, as, for instance, Hannah's Song, the defeat of the Philistines by a tempest, Samuel's warning against kings, the fall of rain in the harvest-season at Samuel's prayer, Saul's rejection, Nathan's promise to David of blessings for his posterity, etc. The book of *Kings* is written in the tone of the book of Deuteronomy, and all the misfortunes of either the Northern or the Southern Kingdom are systematically put down to the worship of Baal and other false gods. The legend of Elijah, with its incidents of vengeful or triumphal fire, is manifestly drawn from an old sun-myth. Detached pieces of the book of *Joshua* belong to the same school of writers, the chief being chaps. i.; xi. to xiii. 14; xxiii., etc. The book of Joshua is, however, made up of exceedingly miscellaneous fragments; a number have already been referred to as due to the combined document which is based on the Yahvist and Elohist. The prophet *Ezekiel* used to preach to the exiles by the river Chebar. The winged creatures which he sees in vision were no doubt suggested by the Babylonian sculptures. Ezekiel rebukes the sins of Judah, and proclaims the wrath of Yahveh upon Gentile nations; but finally Jerusalem vanquishes the army of Gog (? Babylon), and a new Temple is built and the land of Canaan again divided among the twelve tribes. To this period we must most likely assign an interesting section of the book of Leviticus (chaps. xvii. to xxvi.), which critics have agreed to call the *Law of Holiness*. It is so named because, in order to enforce its precepts regarding sacrifice, festivals, the Day of Atonement, the jubilee year of rest, etc., the writer continually appeals to the holiness of the Lord God. It is this document which contains the altruistic maxim, "Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself." The language bears much resemblance to that used by Ezekiel, and quite differs from the style of the rest of the book of Leviticus. When the hosts of Cyrus were about to enter Babylon, and the day of Hebrew liberty had nearly arrived, two songs of exultation

were composed. One has been attached to the book of Jeremiah (chaps. l. and li.), and it tells of the sound of great destruction in the land of the Chaldæans. Another is contained in Isaiah xiii., xiv. 1–23; it dwells, in graphic diction, upon the downfall of the splendid city, and its descent, as degraded Lucifer, into the sad recesses of the underground Sheol. Then Babylon fell (538), though without the slaughter and ruin which these Hebrew prophets had anticipated. As the Jews returned to their fatherland, their emotions were fervently expressed by the unknown *Poet of the Restoration*, sometimes alluded to as Isaiah II. (book of Isaiah, the main portion of chaps. xl. to lv.). His poem is one of the masterpieces of Biblical literature. "Comfort ye, my people," are his opening words; and he awakens trust and hope by displaying the sublimity of God, who forms light and creates darkness, and by revealing striking and beautiful visions of a New Jerusalem, with agate casements and foundations of sapphire. Another poet (whose work is incorporated in the *Restoration* chapters) symbolises the afflicted and chastened Jewish exiles under the figure of a SERVANT, who bears all the sins of his race. The chapters lvi. to lix. take up a mournful and reproachful attitude, and lament the unhappy condition of the Hebrew people; and it is not probable that they come from the pen of the Poet of the Restoration. The joyous strain is resumed by yet another writer in chapters lx. to end, and magnificent scenes of the Golden Age are spread before the imagination.

Perchance an even greater genius was manifested by the unknown author of the poem of *Job*. The author took for his basis an old folk-tale (Job i., ii., and xlii., 7 to end), which told of the patriarch's calamities and happy compensation; and he composed, in verse, a noble dialogue, in which Job, his three friends, and Yahveh himself discuss the question, Why should a righteous man suffer pain? The poet is essentially a Stoic and Agnostic, for no real answer to the problem is forthcoming. The poem concludes at xlii. 6. There are several interpolations, such as

the whole of the "Wisdom" chapter (xxviii.), and most of xxvii. To these we must add all the speeches of Elihu (xxxii. to xxxvii.), which were inserted by some person who was not satisfied with the doctrine of the original poem.

Some psalms may date from the exile period—*e.g.*, cii.—in which the sorrowing psalmist compares himself with a pelican in the wilderness; li. is deeply pathetic; lxx. is a supplication in distress; and lxvi. to lxix. suggest outbursts of gladness on the return of the exiles.

In 520 the Jews began rebuilding the ruined Temple, and the prophet Haggai stimulated them with emphatic appeals and promises of future national glory. And *Zechariah* unfolded his apocalypses of celestial horses; the four horns broken by four smiths; the angel measuring Jerusalem; Joshua, the High Priest, confronting Satan, the accuser; the golden candlestick; the flying roll; the woman enclosed in the basket, etc. (Zechariah i. to viii.).

It is singular that chapters xxxvi. to xxxix. of the book of *Isaiah* should be practically the same as *2 Kings* xviii. 13 to xx. 19.

Note.—The Chinese sages Confucius and Lao-tse taught in this century. India was listening to the gospel of Buddha. Persian armies conquered Egypt and Babylonia. Pythagoras laboured to reform the morality of public and private life among the Greeks. Solon legislated for Athens, and Greece heard the lyrics of Anacreon, Pindar, and Simonides. The Tarquins were expelled from Rome.

Fifth Century B.C.—Reflective minds among the educated Jews had concluded that the people needed rousing by a new call and a new book. Accordingly one or more authors collected a number of old laws and traditions, and re-wrote them in a connected history and book of legislation, which critics speak of as the *Priests' Code.* This was read to the citizens of Jerusalem in 444. It covers eighty-five chapters of the Bible—eleven in Genesis, nineteen in Exodus, all Leviticus (including the "Law of Holiness"), twenty-eight in Numbers, and portions of Joshua. The first page of the Old Testament belongs to it—"In the

beginning God created," etc. It pursues a systematic course, relating events in order, without imagination and picturesque embellishments: paying close attention to families and pedigrees, and presenting in great detail the regulations as to sacrifices, priestly vestments and offices, etc. Its descriptions of the Tabernacle in the Wilderness are almost entirely ideal. No such elaborate system of worship and priesthood existed in early Israel. The reader should take the trouble to mark in his Bible the passages which are derived from the "Priests' Code," viz:—

Genesis i. 1 to ii. 4a; v. 1 to 28, 30 to 32; vi. 9 to 22; vii. 6, 11, 13 to 16a, 17a (except "forty days"), 18 to 21, 24; viii. 1, 2a, 3b to 5, 13a, 14 to 19; ix. 1 to 17, 28, 29; x. 1 to 7, 20, 22, 23, 31, 32; xi. 10 to 27, 31, 32; xii. 4b, 5; xiii. 6, 11b, 12a; xvi. 1a, 3, 15, 16; xvii. all; xix. 29; xxi. 1b, 2b to 5; xxiii. all; xxv. 7 to 11a, 12 to 17, 19, 20, 26b; xxvi. 34, 35; xxvii. 46 to xxviii. 9; xxix. 24, 29; xxxi. 18b; xxxiii. 18a; xxxiv. 1, 2a, 4, 6, 8 to 10, 13 to 18, 20 to 24, 25 (partly), 27 to 29; xxxv. 9 to 13, 15, 22b to 29; xxxvi. (largely); xxxvii. 1, 2a; xli. 46; xlvi. 6 to 27; xlvii. 5, 6a (in the Sept.), 7 to 11, 27b, 28; xlviii. 3 to 6, perhaps 7; xlix. 1a, 28b to 33; l. 12, 13. *Exodus* i. 1 to 5, 7, 13, 14; ii. 23b to 25; vi. 2 to vii. 13, 19, 20a, 21b, 22; viii. 5 to 7, 15b to 19; ix. 8 to 12; xi. 9, 10; xii. 1 to 20, 28, 37a, 40, 41, 43 to 51; xiii. 1, 2, 20; xiv. 1 to 4, 8, 9, 15 to 18, 21a, 21c to 23, 26, 27a, 28a, 29; xvi. 1 to 3, 6 to 24, 31 to 36; xvii. 1a; xix. 1, 2a; xxiv. 15 to 18a; xxv. 1 to xxxi. 18a; xxxiv. 29 to 35, all xxxv. to xl. *Leviticus* i. to xvi.; and xxvii. *Numbers* i. 1 to x. 28; xiii. 1 to 17a, 21, 25, 26a (to "Paran"), 32a; xiv. 1, 2, 5 to 7, 10, 26 to 30, 34 to 38; all xv.; xvi. 1a, 2b to 7a, 7b to 11, 16, 17, 18 to 24, 27a, 32b, 35, 36 to 40, 41 to 50; all xvii. to xix.; xx. 1a (to "month"), 2, 3b, 4, 6 to 13, 22 to 29; xxi. 4a (to "Hor"), 10, 11; xxii. 1; xxv. 6 to 18; xxvi. to xxxi.; xxxii. 18, 19, 28, to 32; all xxxiii. to xxxvi. *Deuteronomy* i. 3; xxxii. 48 to 52; xxxiv. 1a, 5b, 7 to 9. *Joshua* iv. 13, 19; v. 10 to 12; vii. 1; ix. 15b, 17 to 21; xiii. 15 to 32; xiv. 1 to 5; xv. 1 to 13, 20 to 44, 45 to 47, 48 to 62; xvi. 4 to 8; xvii. 1a, 3, 4, 7, 9a, 9c to 10a; xviii. 1, 11 to 28; xix. 1 to 8, 10 to 46, 48, 51; xx. 1 to 3 (except "and unawares"), 6a (to "judgment"), 7 to 9; xxi. 1 to 42; and perhaps xxii. 9 to 34. (This useful table is taken from

Driver's *Introduction to the Literature of the Old Testament*, 6th ed., p. 159.)

The letters *a* and *b* indicate the first and second halves of verses; the letter *c* stands for the last third of a verse.

Before long the idea arose that it would be well to combine this new Code with the older manuscripts of the "Yahvist" and "Elohist" and *Deuteronomy*, and thus was formed the *Hexateuch* = Six books—namely, Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Joshua. When *Joshua* was detached, there remained the Pentateuch, to which was attributed a specially sacred character as the supposed work of Moses. (It is also called the Torah.)

A vigorous prophecy, perhaps of this date, has been appended to the book of *Zechariah* (xii. to xiv., except xiii. 7 to 9). It predicts the cleaving of the Mount of Olives, the issue of miraculous streams from Jerusalem, and the supremacy of Judah over all nations. *Malachi* condemned the Jews for their unfaithfulness to Yahveh's cause, and announced that a powerful messenger should come, strong like Elijah, to purify the nation from their immorality and irreligion. Piece by piece, various poets were adding to that noble collection of the *Psalms* in which the meditations of the pious, the sorrows of the oppressed, the pride of the priests, and the aspirations of the nation at large mingled their varied and impressive utterances. Possibly at this time appeared the striking declarations of an unknown prophet now recorded in *Isaiah* xxiv. to xxvii. The seer tells of ruin far and wide upon the earth; but from the gloom the people of Yahveh emerge in safety and bliss, death is swallowed up in victory, and tears are wiped from all eyes. The charming story of *Ruth* the gleaner and her wedding with Boaz probably took its present literary form at this juncture. Two other books, the dates of which are not easy to determine, may be placed here as a fairly approximate position. One is *Jonah*, with its grotesque version of an old sun-myth (the sun is swallowed by the night-monster) and its humanitarian lesson of kindness

towards the Gentile people and the dumb cattle of Nineveh. The other is *Joel*, a prophecy which agitates the reader by its vivid images of the destroying locusts, and of the terrible battle in the valley of Jehoshaphat.

Note.—Persia still held sway over Egypt and Babylonia. In India the great Law-book of *Manu* had come into vogue as a sacred authority, and the epic poem of the *Mahabharata*, celebrating the deeds of the god Krishna, was taking its earliest form. About this period the *Smaller Avesta* added new poems to the sacred books of the Parsees. The fifth century was marked in Greek history by the battles of Marathon, Thermopylæ and Platæa, the Peloponnesian War and Athenian expedition to Sicily, the public teaching of Socrates, the dramatic works of Æschylus, Sophocles, Euripides, and Aristophanes, and the erection of the Parthenon. The Roman annals tell of the battle of the Lake Regillus, leadership of Cincinnatus, and the beginning of fusion between the patricians and plebeians. It is worthy of remark that about the time the Hebrews issued their *Priests' Code* the Romans were completing their renowned *Law of the Twelve Tables.*

Fourth Century B.C.—This period was not productive of noteworthy Jewish literature. The *Proverbs*, which had been slowly accumulating in the national speech and literature, were combined, about the fourth century B.C., into one volume. Of this book the chief sections are the *Appeal of Wisdom* (i. to ix.), the *Proverbs of Solomon* (x. to xxii. 16), the *Words of the Wise* (xxii. 17 to xxiv. 22, and further sayings from xxiv. 23 to 34), the *Proverbs copied by Hezekiah's Scribes* (xxv. to xxix.), the sarcastic *Sayings of Agur* (xxx.), the *Advice to Lemuel* (xxx. 1–6), and the *Praise of the good housewife* (conclusion).

Note.—The battle of Issus took place in 333, and Persia and Egypt succumbed to the power of Alexander. Parts of the sacred Buddhist books (the *Tripitaka*) were composed, though not written. Socrates was martyred; Plato taught in the Academy; Aristotle wrote on politics, ethics, etc., and Greek art produced the beautiful tomb of Mausolos.

Third Century B.C.—About 300 a priestly editor put together the books of *Chronicles*, *Ezra*, and *Nehemiah*, which are all written in much the same style and language, and which carry the history of Israel from the days of David

to the time of the second Temple and the Priests' Code. The compiler made use of memoirs left by Ezra the scribe and Nehemiah the reformer. Parts of the book of Ezra (iv. 8 to 23, v. 1 to vi. 18, vii. 12 to 26) are given in Aramaic, the Syrian language which was gradually displacing Hebrew in the popular usage. There are traces of Aramaic in the song of *The Shulamite*, or *Song of Solomon*. According to an older view, this pleasing, though floridly-written, poem relates the vain attempts of King Solomon to win a village maiden who has given her heart to a shepherd lover. But later critics see in it a series of Syrian wedding-songs, which allude to a sword-dance, the beauty of the bride, the wooing of the king (bridegroom), the processions, etc. The romantic tale of *Esther* is the fiction which gives a brilliant destiny to the Jew Mordecai, and represents the Jews as revelling in wholesale slaughter of their enemies all over the Persian Empire. The story is apparently based on an old Babylonian legend, for "Esther" suggests the goddess Istar, and "Mordecai" calls to mind the god Marduk. A pessimistic author placed his reflections on the emptiness of human life and glory in the mouth of king Solomon, who has renounced the world and turned *Koheleth* or Preacher *(Ecclesiastes)*. This book is also marked by Aramaic phrases. No doubt the *Psalms* were added to. The Jews were separating into two parties, the puritan Chassids and the secular-minded Hellenists. In Psalms i. and cxix. are expressed the devout sentiments of the Chassids. The Hebrews already regarded their older literature as sacred, and they were slowly adding more leaves to the scriptures, so that, by the time Christianity arose, the Old Testament canon, as we now have it, was all completely recognised.

Note.—The Jews of the Diaspora—*i.e.*, in the settlements outside Palestine—now largely spoke Greek, and it was found convenient to translate, first the Pentateuch, and then other portions of the Old Testament, into a Greek version, known as the Septuagint. It was finished in the second century B.C. Judæa was a province of Syria, but the

High Priests held much political dignity. In China, at the beginning of the third century, Meng-tse or Mencius was teaching. The Buddhist *Katha Vatthu* was composed, and the Buddhist king Asoka was propagating the religion of Gautama. Egypt was ruled by the Ptolemies. The strength of Greece was declining. Archimedes represented the genius of Greek science. Rome subdued all Italy and grappled with Carthage in the two Punic Wars.

Second Century B.C.—Judæa passed through a time of deep tribulation when Antiochus Epiphanes, the Syrian king, attempted to uproot the Jewish national religion, and was opposed by the patriotism of the Maccabean leaders. The anguish of the Hebrew people is uttered in a number of so-called "Maccabean psalms" (xliv., lxxiv., lxxix., and perhaps others which exhibit the Chassids as despised and derided, and as sheep appointed for slaughter). While Judas Maccabeus valiantly wrestled with the Syrian oppressor, an unknown writer issued the book of *Daniel*, which first held up to the Jewish warriors the example of the heroic Daniel, and then, in a series of visions, traced the course of recent events in Syrian and Hebrew history, ending at the period of shame and trial, which had not yet, but would soon (so he said), come to a happy conclusion. The book appeared about 164 B.C. From chapter ii. 4 to the end of vii. it uses the Aramaic language. Slight additions may have been occasionally made to the books of the Old Testament, but on the incorporation of the book of Daniel they were practically completed. (But Canon Cheyne thinks *Ecclesiastes* may belong to the age of Herod the Great.)

At the public worship of the Jews speakers would often explain in Aramaic the meaning of the original Hebrew Scriptures; and the best of these commentaries were repeated and committed to memory, and were known as *Targums*. Jewish philosophy and discussions on the Law and all kinds of religious and social subjects were gradually accumulated, though not yet written, in a mass of notes which grew into the celebrated Talmud. The books known

as the *Apocrypha* were now appearing. They had, in fact, been published too late for inclusion in the canon of the Old Testament. To the second century B.C. belong *Ecclesiasticus*, *1 Esdras*, and *Tobit*. Other Jewish writings of this century were the Allegories, which formed the oldest part of the *Book of Enoch*, and the most ancient portion of the *Sibylline Oracles*, Greek verses written by a Jewish poet, and prophesying the downfall of the enemies of his race. The *Book of Jubilees* (or *Little Genesis*) was written by a Pharisee between 135 and 104 B.C. It reviews the history of the world (as conceived by the author) from the Creation to the revelation of the Law on Sinai.

Note.—Greece had now become a Roman province, and the Roman legions destroyed Carthage. Terence wrote his Comedies.

First Century B.C.—More books now ranked as Apocrypha were issued—*1* and *2 Maccabees*, *Judith*, *The Rest of Esther*, the *Additions to Daniel*, *Wisdom*, and possibly *Baruch*. There also appeared the "Similitudes," which were added to the *Book of Enoch*, and this remarkable work was finally edited about the close of the pre-Christian era. The *Psalms of the Pharisees* (or of *Solomon*) belong to the middle of the century, and refer in some passages to Pompey.

Note.—The sacred books of the Buddhists, the *Tripitaka*, were reduced to writing about 100 B.C.; and later the Buddhist work entitled *The Questions of King Milinda* was composed. Pompey conquered Judæa in 63. Julius Cæsar represented the greatness of Roman statesmanship. Octavius was raised to the Imperial throne in 27. Roman literature was adorned with the names of Varro, Cicero, Lucretius, Catullus, Sallust, Virgil, Horace, Tibullus, Propertius, Livy, and Ovid.

First Century C.E.—The first Christian literature meets us in the shape of Paul's letters to various Christian societies. About the year 53 or 54 he penned *1 Thessalonians*, an affectionate epistle, in which he reminds his friends how he laboured for his own living. Some

passages may have been interpolated—*e.g.*, ii. 14–16. A few years later (about 57 or 58) Paul wrote *1 Corinthians*, a composition remarkable for its picture of the character of early Christian meetings and communities, and for its eloquent declaration of belief in the Resurrection doctrine. Soon afterwards he sent to Corinth a *Letter of Expostulation*, in which he pleads his claim, by right of suffering and toil, to the honour of Apostleship. This letter has become attached to 2 Cor., and comprises chapters x. to xiii. The (so-called) *Second Epistle to the Corinthians* followed (2 Cor. i. to ix.). It suggests a feeling of depression on the part of the writer, and he expresses a hope for a recompense after his afflictions. About this time he communicated with the Christians at Ephesus; and a portion of the epistle, which we may call a *Fragment of a Letter to the Ephesians*, now occupies a place in *Romans* (chap. xvi. 1–20); it contains a list of salutations to friends. About 58 Paul sent a letter to the *Galatians*, in which he dwelt, in eager and vivid language, upon his doctrine of Moral Freedom, and the obsolete character of all Jewish ritual and religious routine. In the same year (58)—so one would gather from the great similarity in tone and diction—Paul wrote his letter to the *Romans* (i. to xiv. 23). Here he pursues the same themes, and represents the Gospel as a new liberty built upon the old Mosaic system; love, he urged, was the truest fulfilment of the Law. The 15th chapter does not bear the stamp of genuineness. Portions of the letter to the *Colossians* have the Pauline method—the disdain for circumcision and sabbaths, the new and ideal man who discards all features of Greek, or Jew, or barbarian; and the kindly messages to friends. So also, in the epistle to the *Ephesians*, there are Pauline passages which commend the faith of the Saints, declare the Christian fellowship open to circumcised or uncircumcised, exhort to gentleness and charity, and to the wearing of the armour of light. While in prison Paul sent an appeal to *Philemon* to take back the runaway slave Onesimus, who had joined the Christian Way

under the Apostle's persuasion. From Rome (62 or 63) he dispatched the epistle to the *Philippians*. In this he rejoices at the progress of the Christian movement, warns against Judaism, and exhorts to a steady advance towards the mark of the high calling. One or two passages are doubtful—*e.g.*, "Beware of the dogs," an expression not usual in Paul's writings. In iii. 1 the words, "Finally, my brethren," may indicate the real end of the letter, and what follows may be part of another letter. Also from prison Paul wrote to *Timothy* (ii. Tim.) a letter which, we may suspect, has been considerably interpolated. The genuine sections will probably be those which refer to Timothy's education, the apostle's imprisonment, the kindnesses he had received from some, the coldness from others, and his need of books, a cloak, and, most of all, sympathetic companionship. Paul is believed to have died in 64.[1]

Not long after Paul's death an obscure Jewish sect in Asia Minor had suffered persecution, and one of their number, Antipas, had met a martyr's fate. An imaginative adherent of this party—whose chief tenet seems to have been an expectation of a warlike Messiah—wrote a series of visions in a *Book of the Unveiling*, or *Apocalypse* (Revelation iv. to xxii. 5), in which the final judgments of God upon the pagan world were described in scenes of storm and blood. Since it refers to the death of Cæsar Nero (the Beast, the letters of whose name stand for the number 666), this fierce manifesto may have been written in 68. Another disciple of this Messianic sect probably wrote the *Seven Epistles* to the seven groups or Churches (Rev. i. 9 to iii.). The allusions to Jesus throughout the Apocalypse are few, and, if these few phrases are removed, the Jewish character of the work is at once clear. *A small Christian apocalypse is found in the so-called *Second Epistle to the Thessalonians*, which tells of the fiery coming of Jesus Christ, and the

[1] An article by Professor van Manen in vol. iii. of the *Encyclopædia Biblica* throws doubt on every epistle ascribed to Paul.

impending destruction of the Son of Perdition, the Man of Sin, the Lawless One. This document is written in Paul's name, but has only one or two sentences suggestive of his style —*e.g.*, the allusion to his self-reliance in earning his bread (iii. 8). Yet another apocalypse is found in the *Prophecy of the Last Days*, which has become embedded in the three Synoptic Gospels (Matt. xxiv. 1–44 and x. 17–23; Mark xiii. 1–37; Luke xvi. 5–36). It forewarns against false Messiahs, prepares for the fall of Jerusalem, and looks for the coming of the Son of Man. Its date may be 68. A quieter atmosphere is suggested by the epistle of *James*, one of the finest pamphlets of the New Testament. Its doctrine is simple and ethical; it teaches patience, mutual goodwill, and sincerity, and severely condemns displays of class-feeling at Christian meetings. The *Epistle to the Hebrews* brings out hidden meanings from the Jewish Law and ritual, and leads up to the High-priesthood of Christ and the Eternal City.

Various persons, no doubt, made records of the traditions and legends which had collected round the memory of the obscure Galilean peasant who had perished shortly after his entry into Jerusalem with a band of rustic followers. The earliest documents have been lost. One of them, sometimes spoken of by critics as the *Common Tradition*, contained parables, speeches, and incidents which are repeated in the first three of the extant gospels. Towards the end of the first century, perhaps (but the whole question rests in cloud and uncertainty), the short gospel of *Mark* appeared at Rome. The last paragraph (xvi. 9–20) was a subsequent addition. And it may be that at this time an early form of the gospel of *Matthew* was composed.

The other Jewish or Christian literature of this century included the following:—The *Assumption of Moses* (written between 7 and 30), portraying the corruption of the house of Herod, and predicting convulsions in heaven and earth, and the deliverance of Israel; the *Books of the Maccabees*,

iii., *iv.*, *v.*; more *Sibylline Oracles* (about 80), resembling the Apocalypse of Asia Minor; the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, in which each of the twelve sons of Jacob leaves counsel for his descendants; and a group of works—the *Martyrdom of Isaiah* (telling how the prophet was sawn asunder), the *Vision of Isaiah*, and the *Testament of Hezekiah*. (These three last-mentioned books were collected into one work, entitled *The Ascension of Isaiah*.) The visions of *2 Esdras (Ezra)* foretold the Day of Judgment and the downfall of Rome. The *Apocalypse of Baruch* intimates the approach of a Golden Age; the *Didache*, or *Teaching of the Apostles*, exhibits the morality and simple piety of a Jewish sect, and gives the parable of the Two Ways of Life and Death. All these (except the *Vision of Isaiah* and the *Testament of Hezekiah*) were Jewish productions, and several of them were afterwards altered to suit Christians' views.

Note.—In this century the Buddhist scriptures first found their way to China. The worship of Mithra, the sun-god, was widespread through the Roman Empire. The chief emperors of the century were Augustus (died 19), Tiberius, Caligula, Claudius, Nero, Galba, Otho, Vitellius, Vespasian, Titus (who subdued Jerusalem in 70), Domitian, Nerva, and Trajan. In the reign of Titus, Pompeii and Herculaneum were overwhelmed by the ashes of Vesuvius (79). Among classical authors may be named Quintilian, Statius, Martial, Lucan, Silius, the elder Pliny, Seneca, Juvenal, the younger Pliny, Tacitus, Dion Chrysostom, and Plutarch. Epictetus wrote his *Encheiridion*. Apollonius of Tyana, a Pythagorean and travelling preacher, attained a great reputation, and a temple was erected to his memory. Apion lectured against the Jews, and Josephus wrote against Apion, besides publishing his well-known historical works. Philo Judæus was writing in Alexandria.

Second Century C.E.—The gospel of *Matthew* was added to, but parts of it as now known—*e.g.*, the first two chapters, and the mention of the "Father, Son, and Holy Ghost" (xxviii. 19)—were not inserted till later. The *Gospel of the Hebrews* (of which only fragments remain) was produced about the same time as "Matthew." The gospel of *Luke* appeared. At Rome, about 112, was com-

posed the epistle entitled *1 Peter*. It imitates the language of Paul and James, and enjoins a blameless and charitable life; and its reference to Christ the Lamb without blemish indicates the gradual development of the Messiah-Lamb conception of the Apocalypse. The letters *1* and *2 Timothy* were interpolated. The epistle of *Titus* was issued under cover of Paul's name, but its anxiety for the preservation of "sound words" points to an age later than Paul's when doctrines were becoming conventional; and not only does it advise the saints in general, but it gives special directions that bishops shall avoid intemperance and brawling. The book of *Acts*, which has very little historical value, may have seen the light about 120–130. Paul's epistles to the *Colossians* and *Ephesians* were rewritten, and the Gnostic phrases were introduced (especially into the later—*e.g.*, "sophia," "pleroma," "phronesis," etc.). In the letter of *Jude* occur vehement denunciations of heretics—perhaps Gnostics. Of the three epistles called *1, 2, 3 John*, in that to the *Little Children* we have mystical meditations on Light, Life, Love, and Propitiation by Blood; in that to the *Elect Lady* a warning against Antichrist; in that to *Gaius* the false teacher Diotrephes is censured. About 138 may have appeared the *Fourth Gospel* (John), with its new and philosophical presentation of the Christian religion; the twenty-first chapter being a subsequent insertion. The last book of the New Testament, *2 Peter*, came out, possibly, about 150–170. It decries cunningly-devised fables and heretical teachers, and recommends Christians to read Paul's epistles. In a singular manner it copies the epistle of St. Jude.

At an uncertain point in the first half of the second century we must place the *Gospel of Peter*. Perhaps to this period belongs the fragment known as *Logia Jesou*, or *Sayings of our Lord* ("Except ye keep the Sabbath, ye shall not see the Father"; "Raise the stone, and there thou shalt find me," etc.). Between 95 and 125 was composed the epistle of *Clement* to the Corinthians. The *Teaching of the*

Apostles received Christian re-touchings. Christian material was worked into the Jewish *Martyrdom of Isaiah.* Descriptions of Christ as descended from both Levi and Judah, and as an interceding angel, etc., are introduced into the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs.* In 118 the book of Koheleth was finally received into the Jewish canon. The scholar Akylas made a new Greek translation of the Hebrew Scriptures. In Alexandria was produced the epistle of *Barnabas*, with its grotesque interpretations of Old Testament incidents. About 136 appeared the *Rest of the Words of Baruch:* the first part is a story of the Babylonian exile; the second adds a vision in which the prophet Jeremiah foresees the advent of Christ on the Mount of Olives. The *Shepherd* of Hermas is a beautiful allegory dating 140–155. The *Mishna* (text of the *Talmud*) was still incomplete. Justin Martyr wrote his *Apology* (about 150) and his *Dialogue with Trypho* (Trypho is a Jew). Papias (died 160–170) composed a work now lost, the *Exposition of the Lord's Oracles.* Aristides also wrote an *Apology* (between 138 and 161). The *Sibylline Oracles* were added to. *Polycarp* may or may not have written (about 160) the epistle ascribed to him. Tatian, a disciple of Justin Martyr, combined the four gospels, Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John, into a Harmony called the *Diatessaron*, the date of which lies between 150 and 180.

Note.—The magnificent dialogue known as the *Bhagavadgita* appeared in India in this century. The emperors who ruled Rome were Trajan, Hadrian (died 138), Antoninus Pius (died 161), and Marcus Aurelius (died 180), the author of the famous *Meditations.* Other classical writers were the younger Pliny, Suetonius, Lucian, Celsus, Apuleius, etc.

We have closed our chronology with the publication of 2 Peter, but it must be borne in mind that many years passed before the books now called the New Testament were formed into a fixed and sacred canon.

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